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ARTICLE

Reminder For Christians Of Life Under Islam



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BY PNW STAFF MAY 01, 2026

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While much of the world debates comfort, identity, and politics, there are believers today who are risking everything simply to say the name of Jesus out loud. Not metaphorically. Not socially. Literally. In parts of the Islamic world, choosing Christ can mean losing your freedom, your family, or even your life—and yet, these stories rarely break through the noise of global media.

The silence is not because the persecution isn't real. It's because it is inconvenient, complex, and often ignored. But for Christians willing to look, the truth is unavoidable: the cost of faith is still being paid in full.

The case of Egyptian convert Said Mansour Rezk Abdelrazek is a sobering and urgent reminder. Arrested in 2024, Abdelrazek now stands trial in Cairo not for violence, but for his decision to leave Islam and follow Christ—and for attempting to have that truth reflected on his identity papers. Though apostasy is not formally illegal in Egypt, the system surrounding religious identity effectively criminalizes conversion.

Prosecutors have brought sweeping charges against him, including terrorism-related offenses, undermining national unity, and contempt for Islam. Reports indicate that during his detention, he has suffered physical and psychological abuse, even being hung in a "crucifixion" position and deprived of basic necessities. His trial, now delayed until June, continues within a judicial system widely criticized for its lack of transparency and due process.

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A quieter, but equally revealing situation is unfolding in Algeria. Over the past several years, nearly all Protestant churches have been systematically shut down. What remains of the Christian community has been pushed out of public life and into the shadows—into homes, remote fields, and hidden gatherings. Laws requiring government authorization for non-Muslim worship are enforced in such a way that approval is almost never granted. Christianity, while not outright banned, is effectively squeezed out of visibility.

Yet the Church persists. Believers gather in "house churches" or even outdoors under olive trees, determined to maintain fellowship despite increasing pressure. Their existence exposes a deeper reality: in Algeria, Christianity is tolerated only as long as it remains invisible and controlled. Converts, in particular, face suspicion and social consequences, often treated as threats to the cultural and religious order. And still, the Church grows—quietly, resiliently, and largely unnoticed by the outside world.

Another recent case out of Egypt further underscores how even defending the Christian faith publicly can come at a steep cost. Christian YouTuber Aughustinos Samaan has been sentenced to five years of hard labor after being convicted of "contempt of religion" and "misuse of social media."



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His offense was not inciting violence, but producing online content that defended Christianity and responded to anti-Christian messaging circulating in the country. With a YouTube channel reaching around 100,000 subscribers, Samaan had built a platform focused on Christian apologetics and comparative religion—engaging ideas, asking questions, and offering a defense of his beliefs.

His punishment reveals how narrow the space for Christian expression can become under such systems. When even intellectual or theological responses are treated as criminal acts, it sends a chilling message far beyond one individual case. It tells believers that silence is safer than speech, that conviction must remain private, and that truth—if it contradicts dominant religious narratives—can carry legal consequences. Samaan's sentencing is not just about one man; it reflects a broader reality where even peaceful, reasoned advocacy for Christianity can be met with severe repression.

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In Pakistan, the danger takes a different but equally severe form. Blasphemy laws continue to cast a long shadow over Christian communities. In 2025 alone, several cases emerged of Christians being accused—sometimes on little more than personal disputes—of insulting Islam or the Prophet Muhammad. These accusations can ignite mob violence almost instantly. Homes are burned, neighborhoods attacked, and families forced into hiding. Even when courts eventually dismiss the charges, the fear and destruction remain. For many, life never returns to normal.

Together, these examples reveal a consistent and troubling pattern: in multiple Muslim-majority nations, following Christ—especially as a convert—can trigger legal punishment, social isolation, or violence. And yet, these realities remain largely underreported. The modern media ecosystem often gravitates toward narratives that are politically convenient or culturally familiar. Stories like these, which require nuance and challenge prevailing assumptions, are too often left in the margins.

But for Christians, they should not be ignored.

Scripture reminds us that we are one body. When one part suffers, all suffer. The persecuted Church is not a distant issue—it is a present and pressing reality. The faith that is practiced freely in one part of the world is being tested under fire in another. And while the global spotlight may not shine on these believers, their endurance speaks volumes.

The question is not whether persecution exists. It does. The question is whether we are willing to see it—and what we will do once we do.

Because the silence of the world does not diminish the significance of their suffering. If anything, it amplifies the responsibility of the Church to remember, to pray, and to stand in solidarity. The cost of following Christ has not changed. In some places, it has simply become more visible.

And for those with eyes to see, it is impossible to ignore.

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